

SCHOOL PUBLICATIONS – DIGITAL AND/OR PRINT

The School Board of Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) promotes education excellence by providing students with opportunities to publish their work in a variety of media formats. All school-sponsored student publications, print or digital media, media blogs, and podcasts, are to be held to the highest ethical standards and serve a pedagogical purpose.

A. Authorization. The leadership of each school is responsible for authorizing all school-sponsored student and staff publications in accordance with the appropriate publications manual at that school. Publications manuals must be approved by the principal.

B. Publications Manual. Publication manuals shall be adopted at each school to guide all student publications to include a mission statement for the publication and relevant guidelines for that publication to ensure fulfillment of this policy.

C. Prohibited Content. The following content is prohibited in the publication of materials:

1. Disruptive Content. This includes materials that have caused, are causing, or could reasonably lead the principal to expect substantial disruption of or interference with school activities and operations. This also includes, but is not limited to, materials that advocate prejudice, hatred, violence, or harassment.

2. Obscene and Sexually Explicit Content. This includes materials that are considered obscene or considered harmful to juveniles, as defined in [Section 18.2-372 of the Code of Virginia](#) or that are considered as sexually explicit content as defined in [Section 2.2-2827](#), as set forth in [Policy 5055](#). Nothing in this policy requires or permits the prohibition of school publication materials as sexually explicit or obscene based solely upon reference to a person's sexual orientation or gender identity.

3. Content That Compromises Student or Staff Safety. This includes materials that advocate practices that could endanger the health or safety of students or staff.

4. Content That Endorses Unlawful Activity. This includes materials that advocate for the commission of a criminal act or is a criminal act, as defined by the Criminal Code of the United States, the Commonwealth of Virginia, or Loudoun County, that advertise or advocate for illegal products or services, or that advocate for the violation of a lawful school policy or regulation.

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5. Content That Compromises the Privacy or Reputation of an Individual.

This includes materials that are libelous or slanderous (i.e., defamatory), damage the reputation of an individual, cause personal humiliation, mental anguish or suffering, cause other injuries, or constitute an unwarranted invasion of privacy.

[Former Policy 8-49]

Adopted: 9/13/76

Revised: 6/22/93, 12/13/11, 6/12/18, 02/27/24

Current Revision: 09/04/24

Leg Ref: Code of Virginia § [18.2-372](#); [2.2-2827](#)

Cross Ref: [Policy 5055](#), Parental Notification of Instructional Materials with Sexually Explicit Content; [Policy 8-65](#), Solicitation, Distribution and Posting